

Jorge Paredes

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconometrics • Causal Inference • Development Economics • Political Economy • Nowcasting

EDUCATION

Barcelona School of Economics

MSc. in Economics and Finance — degree awarded by Universitat Pompeu Fabra and Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona

Barcelona, Spain

09/2024 – 08/2025

- Thesis: *The Social Fallout of Sovereign Default Risk in the LAC Region*. Advisors: Isaac Bailey, Ph.D., and Victoria Vanasco, Ph.D.

Universidad San Francisco de Quito (USFQ)

BSc. in Economics

Quito, Ecuador

08/2017 – 05/2021

- Thesis: *The Cleansing Effect in Emerging Markets: Evidence from Ecuador*. Advisor: Carlos Uribe, Ph.D.
- Dean's List (several semesters).

WORKING PAPERS & PUBLICATIONS

1. "Nudging the Agents: Does It Reduce Discrimination Against Migrants in the House Rental Market?" with W. Zanoni, L. Díaz, E. Díaz, and P. Acevedo. IDB Working Paper No. IDB-WP-1517, November 2023.
2. "Emerging Markets Bond Index Performance and Sovereign Default: The Case of Ecuador." with W. Zanoni, E. Díaz, L. Andrian, and J. L. Maldonado. IDB Working Paper No. IDB-WP-1569, March 2024.
3. "Exploring Gender Discrimination: A Multi-Trial Field Experiment in Urban Ecuador." with W. Zanoni and S. Duryea. December 2024.
4. "Assessing the Emissions Risks of Agricultural Support Policies: A Meta-Analytical Framework." with J. Ilicic and S. Guerrero. FAO Working Paper (*under revision*).

Work in Progress

1. "Growth Interrupted: The Dynamic Effects of Political Instability on Economic Performance in Peru." with W. Zanoni and J. Beverinotti. IDB Working Paper.
2. "Surviving the Storm: Exploring the Cleansing Effect and Firm Closures in Ecuador."
3. "Transportation Effects on Early Truancy in Chilean Schools, 2016–2023."
4. "Too Dry to Fertilize, Too Wet to Care: Farmer Anticipation Under El Niño." with A. Velasco.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO)

Economist Intern — Agrifood Economics and Policy Division (ESA); PRIME / MAFAP

Rome, Italy

02/2026 – Present

- Estimated eight econometric and machine-learning models (probit, GEE, mixed-effects probit, elastic net, random forest, XGBoost, SVM, CART) across five specifications and four robustness samples on a meta-analytic dataset of 197 observations from 28 studies, with parallelized leave-one-study-out cross-validation and publication-bias testing.
- Designed and built a modular, reproducible R ETL pipeline integrating five international data sources (FAOSTAT, UN Comtrade, IMF, World Bank WDI and GEM) into a harmonized cross-country panel of 24 developing countries (2000–2025) for MAFAP price-incentive monitoring, with rule-based frequency harmonization, provenance tracking, an automated coverage inventory, and an interactive Shiny dashboard.
- Built a reproducible Python-to-R pipeline that extracts and standardizes government budget data from heterogeneous PDF budget books into a unified long-format dataset, classifying expenditure into 12 MAFAP categories via deterministic record linkage and a two-stage (lookup + web-research) protocol with LLM-assisted classification.

Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)

Consultant (PEC) for the Research Department

Remotely

03/2026 – 08/2026

- Built the full R analysis codebase for a Banco Central del Ecuador–IDB loan-level impact evaluation of Ecuador's 2024 microcredit reclassification reform, processing ~800,000 administrative loan records.
- Implemented difference-in-differences and event-study designs with high-dimensional fixed effects and lender × income bin clustered standard errors across seven credit outcomes, including market-structure heterogeneity by local concentration.

Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)
External Consultant (PEC) for Peru Office

Remotely
09/2025 – 12/2025

- Constructed a quarterly cross-country panel (2006–2024) on political instability and macroeconomic performance from V-Dem, World Bank GEM/WDI, and IMF sources, and designed a DBSCAN algorithm to detect instability episodes from clustered presidential turnovers.
- Estimated the dynamic GDP-growth cost of political instability using augmented synthetic control with conformal inference and staggered synthetic control with wild-bootstrap inference, finding a reduction of ≈ 1.5 – 2.5 pp in annual GDP growth and a $\sim 12\%$ cumulative GDP loss for Peru over its 2016Q3–2024Q4 instability episode relative to the synthetic counterfactual.

Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)
Research Assistant for Ecuador's Economics Senior Specialist

Quito, Ecuador
11/2022 – 12/2024

- Quantified discrimination in labor and real-estate markets across urban South America through field experiments and econometric analysis.
- Built a structural model with a Simulated Method of Moments (SMM) estimator to analyze taxpayer behavior around income-regime thresholds in Ecuador's tax system, under Prof. Juan Pantano.
- Implemented a synthetic control analysis estimating the impact of Ecuador's 2008 sovereign default on EMBI spreads and long-term sovereign risk.

Universidad San Francisco de Quito (USFQ)
Research Assistant for Prof. Carlos Uribe, Ph.D.

Quito, Ecuador
06/2020 – 10/2022

- Developed R packages implementing a Factor-Augmented Vector Autoregression (FAVAR) model for inflation forecasting, and coded output-gap estimation functions tailored for emerging markets, supporting an IDB consultancy secured and led by Prof. Uribe.
- Assisted in grading, problem-set design, and exam development for Intermediate Macroeconomics, Computational Economics, and the Undergraduate Thesis Seminar.

Neo-Plan Cia. Ltda.
Research Assistant

Quito, Ecuador
11/2020 – 11/2021

- Contributed to a feasibility study on establishing a dry port as an extension of Manta's port, assessing economic, logistical, and regulatory factors.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Spanish (native), English (fluent, C1/C2), French (intermediate), Italian (basic), Portuguese (basic).
- **Technical:** R (advanced), $\LaTeX$ (advanced), Stata (advanced), Python (intermediate), Julia (intermediate), MATLAB (intermediate), Git/GitHub (intermediate), Microsoft Excel (intermediate).

REFERENCES

Carlos Uribe, Ph.D.
Associate Professor of Economics, USFQ
cauribe@usfq.edu.ec

Joanna Illicic, Ph.D.
Economist, ESA – AgIncentives, FAO
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Juan Pantano, Ph.D.
Associate Professor of Economics, HKU Business School, The University of Hong Kong
jpanta@hku.hk

Wladimir Zaroni, Ph.D.
Economics Senior Specialist, IDB — Ecuador
wladimirz@iadb.org

Santiago Guerrero, Ph.D.
Environmental Externalities Specialist, ESA, FAO
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Pedro Romero, Ph.D.
Master in Economics Director and Associate Professor of Economics, USFQ
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